



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: The Changing Face of Inuit Society.



Learning Outcome

Understand detailed descriptions of real or imaginary events and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a report about different cultures.
- I can talk about unusual or unique events.
- I can report facts about events or action.

Ask your partner:

- Have you visited a remote community?
- What kind of changes has your community experienced in the last 50 years?





Let's Explore!

Richard is visiting a **Nunavut*** community that is struggling to blend their traditions with the 21st century **influences****.

* "Nunavut" is the largest, northernmost, newest, and least populous territory of Canada.

** "Influences" are things that affect someone or something in an important way.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Recently, I have traveled to Nunavut after being hounded by a journalist on why I hadn't been to this part of Canada yet. I imagined that my one-week stay would involve sleeping in an igloo, traveling around on a dogsled, and hunting for seal. By spending some time with these people, I changed all my previous perceptions of Inuit life. I have only just arrived and I have realized that while some aspects of Inuit culture have remained the same, others have changed quite drastically with the times.

The Inuit today generally live in modern homes, watch TV, listen to popular music, and use the Internet. Motorized sleds called skidoos have replaced dogsleds. Whereas in the past the Inuit spent most of their time working to survive, there is a 60% unemployment rate amongst the Inuit today. Recently, this has been a source of considerable stress, and has represented one of the biggest problems in Inuit society.

After eating a delicious dinner of game bird with the Eejeesiak family, I talked about the changes in the community and in Inuit culture. Before leaving I asked, "Do you think things will ever be the same?" She explained to me that, "one of the most upsetting changes has been the relationship between young and old people. Up to now, the older community members have been a source of wisdom and learning. Recently, the young people have been too influenced by cultures outside the Inuit communities ... which obviously changes the society as a whole." I then asked, "You have seen so many changes, yet you have so much inner strength." She answered that it was their love and respect for the family and for others in the community that allows them to endure. "Things may have changed," she explained. "But by working together to maintain our core values, respect for each other and for the land, we will always remain."





Let's Practice!

Can you talk new experiences and unusual events?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete the gaps with the words from the Word Bank.

Work Bank

have mostly replaced / have changed / have remained / have only just / has been
Up to now / have seen / Recently

1. _____, the older community members have been a source of wisdom and learning.
2. This _____ a source of considerable stress.
3. _____, I have traveled to Nunavut after being hounded by a journalist on why I hadn't been to this part of Canada yet.
4. You _____ so many changes yet you have shown so much inner strength.
5. Motorized sleds called skidoos _____ dogsleds.
6. I _____ arrived and I have realized that while some aspects of Inuit culture have remained the same, others have changed quite drastically with the times.
7. While some aspects of Inuit culture _____ the same, others _____ quite drastically with the times.



Let's Practice!

What did Richard learn on his trip to the wintry north?

Instructions: Match the two halves to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. After eating a delicious dinner with the Eejeesiak family, | a. ____ "Do you think things will ever be the same?" |
| 2. By spending some time with these people, | b. ____ I changed all my previous perceptions of Inuit life. |
| 3. By working together to maintain our core values, | c. ____ respect for each other and for the land, we will always remain. |
| 4. Before leaving I asked, | d. ____ I talked about the changes in Inuit culture. |





Extension Activity

How much do you know about the challenges facing different cultures?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find information about a culture that is trying to blend their culture with 21st century expectations.
- Imagine you visit their community and write a 150-200 word report on their culture and experience in modern society.
- Write about unusual or unique event in the Present Perfect tense. Include words like *until, now, and yet*.
- Proofread your work.
- Read your report to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I find information about a different culture online.

☐ ☐

I write a report about the experiences of a different culture.

☐ ☐

I write about unusual or unique events.

☐ ☐

I read my report about a different community to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to hound** (verb): to chase or bother
e.g. I traveled to Nunavut after being hounded by a journalist.
- igloo** (noun): a house made of blocks of snow or ice
e.g. I imagined that my one-week stay would involve sleeping in an igloo.
- game bird** (noun): a hunted bird
e.g. Over a delicious dinner of game bird with the Eejeesiak family, I talked about the changes in the community and in Inuit culture.
- wisdom** (noun): knowledge that is gained by having many experiences in life
e.g. Up to now, the older community members were the source of wisdom and learning.
- perception** (noun): the way you think about or understand someone or something
e.g. However, this trip has certainly changed all my previous perceptions of Inuit life.
- drastically** (adverb): extreme in effect or action
e.g. Other things have changed quite drastically with the times.
- core** (adjective): most important or most basic
e.g. Our core values, respect for each other and for the land, will always remain.





Learning Points

Elements of a Report

A *report* can be a written or spoken description of a situation or event, giving people the information they need.

A written report includes different elements.

1. A title page which includes a title, the author's name and the date it was written.
2. A summary which includes a short overview on what the report is about.
3. An introduction.
4. A body which includes *subtitles* that provide information about the different sections in the body.
5. A conclusion which wraps up what you talked about in your report.

Examples:

- *Title: The Changing Face of Inuit Identity in the 21st Century*

Author: Richard Rice

Date: August 21st 2016

- *Summary: Balancing Inuit culture and identity within modern day influences can be challenging.*

- *Introduction: This report looks at how some aspects of Inuit culture have remained the same, while others have changed quite drastically with the times.*

- *Subtitles within the Body: Music, Education, Art, Language*

- *Conclusion: This experience has changed all my perception of Inuit life.*





Learning Points

Writing a Report about Unusual Events

You use the **Present Perfect** tense when you want to write about unusual events.

You use the **Present Perfect** tense in a variety of ways:

1. To talk about actions that recently started and may have finished recently or may be continuing. It is normally clear from the context. You use words like *just*, *only just* and *recently* in these constructions.

For example:

Recently, I have traveled to Nunavut after being hounded by a journalist on why I hadn't been to this part of Canada yet. I have **only just** arrived and I have realized that while some aspects of Inuit culture have remained the same, others have changed quite drastically with the times.

1. To talk or ask about experience or your opinion based on experience. You use the word **ever** in questions. You also use the word **yet** in negatives and in questions.

For example:

*Do you think things will **ever** be the same?*

*Have you been to Nunavut **yet**?*

*I haven't **yet** seen that part of Canada.*

Examples:

- *Up to now, the older community members have been a source of wisdom and learning.*
- *Recently, I have traveled to Nunavut after being hounded by a journalist on why I hadn't been to this part of Canada yet.*
- *You have seen so many changes yet you have shown so much inner strength.*
- *I haven't noticed a change until now.*
- *I have only just arrived and I have realized that while some aspects of Inuit culture have remained the same, others have changed quite drastically with the times.*

